

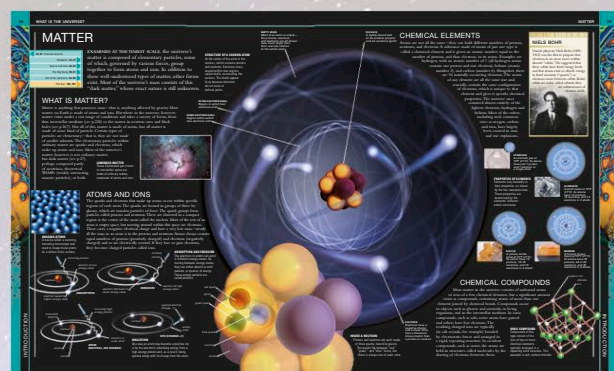
ABOUT THIS BOOK

Universe is divided into three main sections. The **INTRODUCTION** is an overview of the basic concepts of astronomy. **GUIDE TO THE UNIVERSE** looks, in turn, at the solar system, the Milky Way (our home galaxy), and the regions of space that lie beyond. Finally, **THE NIGHT SKY** is a guide to the sky for the amateur skywatcher.

INTRODUCTION

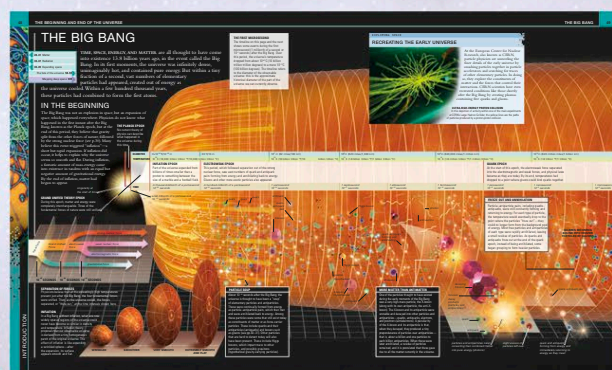


This section is about the universe and astronomy as a whole. It is subdivided into three parts. **WHAT IS THE UNIVERSE?** looks at different kinds of objects in the universe and the forces governing how they behave and interact. **THE BEGINNING AND END OF THE UNIVERSE** covers the origin and history of the universe, while **THE VIEW FROM EARTH** explains what we see when we look at the sky.



△ WHAT IS THE UNIVERSE?

This section begins by looking at some basic questions about the size and shape of the universe. It goes on to explain concepts such as matter and radiation, the motion of objects in space, and the relationship between time and space.



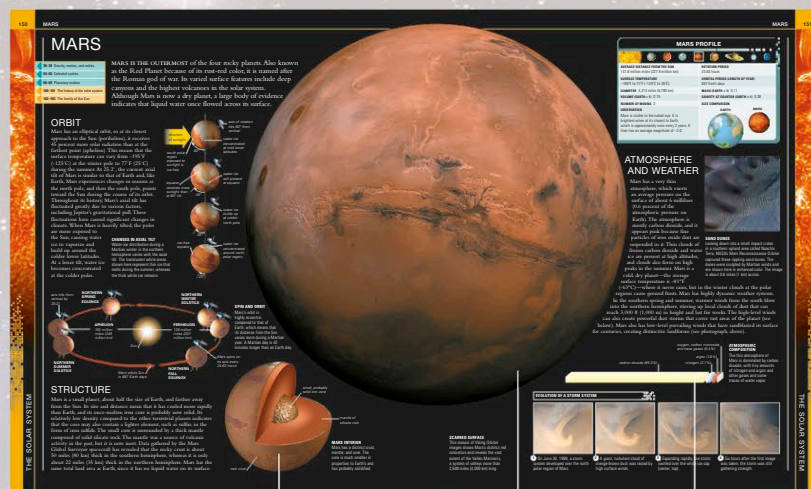
△ THE BEGINNING AND END OF THE UNIVERSE

The universe is thought to have originated in an event known as the Big Bang. This section describes the Big Bang in detail and looks at how the universe came to be the way it is now, as well as how it might end.

GUIDE TO THE UNIVERSE



This part of the book focuses on specific regions of space, starting from the Sun and then moving outward to progressively more distant reaches of the universe. It is divided into three sections, covering the solar system, the Milky Way, and features beyond the Milky Way. In each section, introductory pages describe features in a general way and explain the processes behind their formation. These pages are often followed by detailed profiles of actual features (such as individual stars), usually arranged in order of their distance from Earth.



△ THE SOLAR SYSTEM

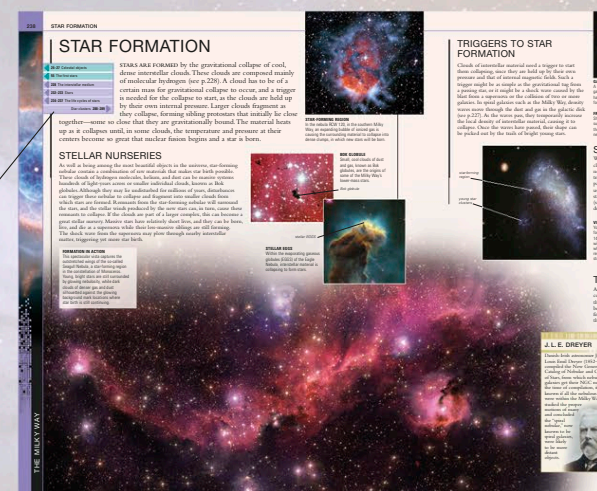
This section is about the Sun and the many bodies in orbit around it. It covers the eight planets one by one and then looks at asteroids, comets, and meteors, as well as the remote regions on the margins of the solar system. For most planets, profiles of individual surface features or moons are also included.

artwork of planet's interior structure

main image shows planet as it appears from space

illustrations show atmospheric composition for each planet

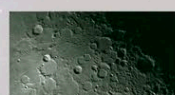
color-coded panel contains references to other relevant sections



THE MILKY WAY

The subject of this section is the Milky Way and the stars, nebulae, and planets that it contains. Pages such as those shown here describe how particular types of features are formed.

THE NIGHT SKY



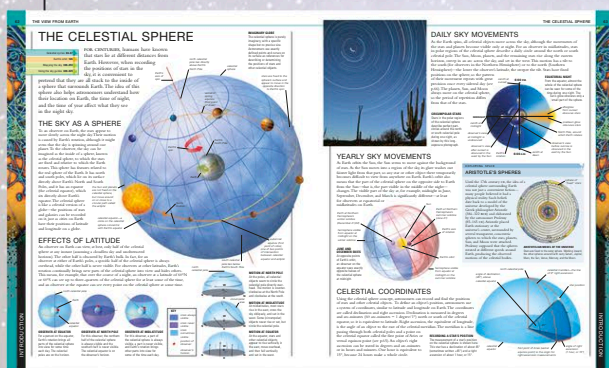
This section is an atlas of the night sky. It is divided into two parts. The first

(**THE CONSTELLATIONS**) is a guide to the 88 regions into which astronomers divide the sky. It contains illustrated profiles of all the constellations arranged according to their position in the sky, with the most northerly ones first and the southernmost last. The second part (the **MONTHLY SKY GUIDE**) is a month-by-month guide containing a summary of the highlights for each month, detailed star charts, and charts showing the positions of the planets.

THE CONSTELLATIONS Each constellation profile is illustrated with a chart, two locator maps, and one or more photographs. A more detailed guide to the section can be found on pp.348–349.

text describes features of interest

detailed chart



△ THE VIEW FROM EARTH

This section presents a simple model for making sense of the changing appearance of the sky. It also contains practical advice on looking at the sky with the naked eye, telescopes, and binoculars.